

Get into the action

Sony and FIFA plan to film and broadcast the 2010 Football World Cup in 3D

Wii like Sony

Sony expected to launch motion controller in Spring 2010 for PS3 Slim

extent. The more user-friendly the interface the better. The interface should let you access a lot of information in a comprehensive manner.

There are several things that go into this – brief write ups available about upcoming programmes, how far ahead does the guide show updates, does the guide show what is currently playing (preview), and so on.

Movies on Demand

With DTH comes the added advantage of playing movies on demand. There are specific channels where movies play



at scheduled start times.

These schedules can be accessed through the service interface or some DTH operators even put it up on their web sites. It's important to note here that the number of channels showing movies on demand is not as important as the kind of movies. Some

players source latest content, while others show movies that are not as recent.

Interactive services

Many providers with the exception of Sun Direct offer interactive services. These services let you interact with the TV. For example, while watching a cooking show, there may be a pop up which says press the red button to see other such recipes.

Widgets-based data

Some DTH providers such as Dish source content from online sources like matrimonial or job services. Others like Airtel allow you to set up widgets that give information and news snippets, weather, stock updates, breaking news on the press of

a button without moving away from the main screen.

Survey findings

We asked members of the Digit community to rate their DTH service on a scale of 1 to 5 on a few parameters such as Picture Quality, Overall reception quality, Package composition and structuring, Pricing and Value Added services. They were even asked to comment on specifics that appeal to them as users and their thoughts while choosing a particular DTH provider. Big, Dish and Airtel received the highest number of votes for being chosen based on pricing.

We also got an idea of which services are more popular. As expected, TataSky was the most popular and formed the largest part of the respondents.

FEATURE SNAPSHOT

	TataSky	Dish TV	BIG TV	Airtel Digital	Sun Direct	Videocon d2h
Quality – MPEG4	DVD	DVD	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
DVB-S2	No	No	No	Yes	No	Yes
Interactive Services	Active Topper	Gaming	iStock	iNet	NA	Active Darshan*
	Active Learning	News Active	iCricket	iLearn		Active Cooking*
	Active Stories	Bhakti Active	iAstro	iNews		Active Travel*
	Active Mall	Astro Active	iCooking	iMatinee		Active Health & Fitness*
	Active English	ICICI Active	iCare	iTravel		
	Active Wizkids	Sports Active	iGames	iAstro		
	Active Games	Multilingual Services	iNews	iSports		
	Active Darshan	Shaadi Active				
	Active Cooking	Jobs Active				
	Active Astrology	Travel Active				
	Active Starnews	Mobile Active				
Packages Model	Base Pack + Add on Pack + Few alacarte	Base Pack + Alacarte	Base package + Add on packs + regional packs	Base Package + Adding next package or Topups	Base pack + Add on + Alacarte	Basepack + Add on
Movies on Demand Channels	7	6	21	6	4	Coming soon
Favourite Channels lists	1 with 20 channel	8 with unlimited	8 with unlimited	4 with 15 channel	No	4 lists with 20 channels each
Naming Favourite list	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Top 10 list	No	No	Yes	No	No	No
Parental control	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Parental control with rating	No	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Language for interface	Single	Single	Single	Single	Single	2 Languages out of 9 available
Customisable hud	No	No	No	No	No	Yes
Ticker/Widgets	No	No	No	Yes	No	Yes

All feature listings as per information on service providers website. Actual differences may occur.

*Some of these features & services may not be currently available, to be introduced shortly